

Question ID: 74028acf

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Expression of Ideas	Transitions	Medium

Question

Topographic maps show the elevation of landforms above sea level. Bathymetric maps, _____ show the elevation of landforms below the sea, providing valuable information to marine geophysicists like Claudia Flores, who studies seismic data from the northeastern Caribbean.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

Answer

- A. in conclusion,
- B. for example,
- C. by contrast,
- D. afterward,

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is the best answer. “By contrast” logically signals that the information about bathymetric maps in this sentence—that they show landforms’ elevation below the sea—presents a direct contrast to the previous information about topographic maps showing landforms’ elevation above sea level.

Choice A is incorrect because “in conclusion” illogically signals that the information about bathymetric maps in this sentence concludes or summarizes the previous information about topographic maps. Instead, the sentence provides contrasting information about bathymetric maps.

Choice B is incorrect because “for example” illogically signals that the information about bathymetric maps in this sentence exemplifies the previous information about topographic maps. Instead, the sentence provides contrasting information about bathymetric maps.

Choice D is incorrect because “afterward” illogically signals that this sentence describes an event that chronologically follows the previous information about topographic maps. Instead, the sentence provides contrasting information about bathymetric maps.